

ARISE

Adolescent Reproductive Health Information Support & Empowerment

LIFE SKILLS

Career Decisions & Planning

Student Study Guide & Quiz Answer Key

Module:	Life Skills
Lesson:	Career Decisions & Planning
Quiz:	25 marks (10 MCQ + 5 Fill-in-blanks + 3 Short Answer)
Pass Mark:	15/25 (60%) — Certificate awarded at 60%+
Languages:	English Kiswahili Sheng

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

1. Apply self-discovery tools to identify personal strengths, values, interests, and personality
2. Compare Kenya's diverse career sectors and education pathways — including TVET, university, trades, and entrepreneurship
3. Identify human skills that AI and automation cannot replace — and explain how to combine them with technology
4. Build a personal career roadmap and identify free Kenya resources for skill development
5. Apply basic financial habits relevant to early career and entrepreneurship in Kenya

Slide 2: Self-Discovery — Know Yourself First

Every great career decision starts with one question: who am I? Knowing your strengths, values, interests, and personality saves you years of wrong turns.

Know This About Yourself	Questions to Ask	Why It Matters for Careers
Your STRENGTHS	What do I do better than most people? What do others ask me for help with?	Careers built on strengths lead to excellence and recognition — not daily struggle
Your VALUES	What matters most to me — helping people, creating things, solving problems, leading, earning?	A high salary in a career that conflicts with your values leads to burnout and unhappiness within years
Your INTERESTS	What topics make me lose track of time? What would I learn even without being paid?	Interest creates intrinsic motivation — workers who love their field outperform those who don't over a lifetime
Your PERSONALITY	Do I prefer working with people, data, ideas, or physical things? Alone or in teams? Indoors or outdoors?	Personality fit prevents daily friction — an introvert in constant public speaking suffers; an extrovert desk-bound daily suffers equally

■ ■ Free Self-Discovery Tools

Slide 3: Kenya's Career Landscape — More Than Tech

Kenya's economy is diverse. The greatest opportunities exist across agriculture, healthcare, trades, creative industries, public service, and more — not only in technology.

Sector	Key Careers	Why It Matters in Kenya	Entry Pathway
Agriculture & Agri-business ■	Agronomist, agritech entrepreneur, floriculturist, horticulturalist, livestock farmer, food processor, cooperative manager	40%+ of employment; Kenya is global leader in cut flowers, tea, horticulture; massive value-addition opportunities	TVET/Diploma in Agriculture, Veterinary Science, Degree, or start farming with knowledge

Sector	Key Careers	Why It Matters in Kenya	Entry Pathway
Healthcare & Social Work ■	Nurse, clinical officer, pharmacist, lab technician, physiotherapist, community health worker, nutritionist, social worker	Critical shortage of healthcare workers across Kenya; government and NGO employment; international recruitment (UK, Germany, Middle East, Canada)	TVET nursing/clinical diploma (2–3 yrs); KNH, KMTTC, county hospitals
Trades & Construction ■	Electrician, plumber, welder, carpenter, mason, auto mechanic, refrigeration technician, solar installer	Kenya's construction boom; extreme shortage of skilled tradespeople; Jua Kali sector; well-paid self-employment; Germany Ausbildung programme for skilled trades	TVET certificate (6–12 months); MTTI and other accredited institutes; apprenticeship
Creative & Media Industries ■	Graphic designer, photographer, videographer, journalist, fashion designer, musician, content creator, architect, interior designer	Kenya's creative economy is growing fast; Nairobi fashion scene; Kenyan film/music globally; NGO communications; digital content demand is insatiable	Portfolio-based; design school; YouTube/online learning; apprenticeship with established creatives
Education & Community Work ■	Teacher, school administrator, early childhood educator, community development officer, NGO programme officer, youth worker, librarian	Kenya has 47 counties all needing educators and community workers; NGO sector is large; government employment; transformative impact on communities	P1 Teaching Certificate (2 yrs); diploma in early childhood; degree in education or community development

Sector	Key Careers	Why It Matters in Kenya	Entry Pathway
Technology & Digital Economy ■	Software developer, data analyst, cybersecurity specialist, digital marketer, UX designer, network engineer, cloud specialist, AI trainer	Silicon Savannah; M-Pesa ecosystem; 47 county digital hubs; remote work opportunities; fastest growing sector globally	TVET ICT; Google Career Certificates (free online); MTTI; coding bootcamps; self-study with portfolio

Slide 4: Education Pathways — Every Route Is Valid

University is one path — not the only path. The best pathway is the one that matches your goals, strengths, and circumstances. Kenya has excellent options at every level.

Pathway	Duration	Best For	Kenya Examples	Cost
University Degree	3–5 years	Medicine, law, engineering, education, business — where degree is required by law or profession	UoN, JKUAT, Strathmore, KU, Egerton, Moi University	KES 60,000–200,000/yr (HELB loans available)
TVET Certificate / Diploma	6 months–2 years	Healthcare (nursing, lab tech), trades (electrical, plumbing), ICT, hospitality, fashion, agriculture	KMTC, MTTI, Kenya Polytechnic, county TVETs, Kenya School of Government	KES 15,000–60,000/yr (much lower cost)
Apprenticeship / On-the-Job	1–3 years	Jua Kali trades (welding, carpentry, auto), salon/beauty, tailoring, photography — learn while earning	Established workshop owners, senior artisans, professional studios	Free or minimal — often earn small wages while learning

Pathway	Duration	Best For	Kenya Examples	Cost
Online / Self-Study	Flexible — weeks to months per course	Digital skills (coding, design, marketing, data), supplementing formal education, career switchers	Google Career Certificates, Coursera, Khan Academy, ALX Africa, Andela, Ajira Digital (Kenya gov)	Free – KES 5,000 (most Google/Coursera certificates are free with financial aid)
Germany Ausbildung Programme	2–3 years in Germany	Healthcare (nursing, elder care), trades, hospitality — for motivated TVET graduates with German language skills	Accredited TVET institutes (MTTI), German Embassy Kenya	Earn while training in Germany (€700–1,000/month training allowance)

Wanjiku's Path — Murang'a to Munich

Wanjiku, 19, Murang'a, scored a C+ in KCSE — not enough for direct university entry. She joined KMTTC for a nursing diploma. During her training, her institution partnered with MTTI for a German language programme. Two years later, Wanjiku passed her B1 German exam and was accepted into an Ausbildung nursing programme in Munich. She now earns €950/month as a trainee nurse, sends money home, and will qualify as a registered nurse in Germany within two years. 'People called my TVET choice a failure,' she says. 'I call it a launchpad.'

Slide 5: Human Skills AI Cannot Replace — Your Edge

AI is a powerful tool — not a replacement for human beings. The people who thrive are those who combine human strengths WITH technological tools, not those who fear or ignore either.

KEY TERM: The Human + AI Partnership

The most valuable workers of the future are not those who resist AI or those who blindly follow it — but those who use AI as a tool while leading with distinctly human strengths. A nurse who uses AI diagnostics AND provides human comfort. A farmer who uses AI yield prediction AND knows their land. A teacher who uses AI resources AND builds relationships.

Human Skill	Why AI Cannot Replicate It	Kenyan Career Where It Is Essential
Empathy & Emotional Intelligence	AI processes language patterns but has no lived experience, genuine feeling, or emotional understanding. A grieving family needs a human, not a chatbot.	Nurse, counsellor, social worker, teacher, pastor, community leader
Creative & Contextual Problem-Solving	AI recombines existing patterns; it cannot make genuinely novel creative leaps that account for local culture, community needs, and lived Kenyan reality.	Architect, product designer, fashion designer, journalist, filmmaker, entrepreneur
Ethical & Moral Judgment	AI optimises for outcomes it is programmed for — it has no conscience, no sense of justice, no understanding of human dignity. Every AI system needs humans to set its ethical guardrails.	Judge, lawyer, doctor, ethics committee member, community elder, policy maker
Leadership & Inspiration	People follow leaders they trust and respect as human beings — not algorithms. Building team loyalty, navigating conflict, and inspiring performance are deeply human arts.	School principal, hospital administrator, NGO director, business owner, pastor, military officer
Manual Dexterity & Physical Presence	Robots exist but remain expensive, limited, and require human oversight. A skilled electrician, surgeon, barber, or farmer operates in environments too variable for current robotics.	Surgeon, electrician, farmer, chef, nurse, hairdresser, plumber, carpenter

Slide 6: Module Video

Watch carefully, then continue to the scenarios.

Slide 7: Real Talk — What Would You Do?

Pick your choice and see the consequence.

Slide 8: Your Career Roadmap + Financial Foundations

You do not need all the answers today. You need a direction, a first step, and the financial habits that will protect whatever you earn.

Career Step	What To Do	Free Kenya Resources
1. Know Yourself	Complete self-discovery exercises — strengths, values, interests, personality	ARISE counsellor, 16Personalities.com, journalling
2. Research 3 Careers	Read job descriptions, salary ranges, pathways, and talk to professionals in those fields	LinkedIn, YouTube interviews, TVET open days, NGO internships
3. Shadow Someone	Spend a day (or week) with a professional in a career you are considering	Family connections, church/mosque networks, school alumni
4. Build One Skill Now	Choose one marketable skill and start developing it today — do not wait for completion	Google Career Certificates (free), YouTube, MTTI, Ajira Digital (gov)
5. Find a Mentor	Identify one professional in your field of interest and ask if they would answer 3 career questions	LinkedIn, professional associations, family networks, church/mosque, school teachers

Quiz — Answer Key

Total: 25 marks | Pass: 15/25 (60%) | Certificate at 60%+

Part A: Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. 1. The FIRST step in making a good career decision is:

- ☐ A. Choosing whichever career pays the most money
- ☒ B. Self-discovery — understanding your strengths, values, interests, and personality before exploring options
- ☐ C. Following your parents' or friends' career choice
- ☐ D. Picking any career and figuring it out later

2. 2. TVET (Technical and Vocational Education and Training) in Kenya:

- ☐ A. Is only for students who fail university entry
- ☒ B. Provides practical, industry-recognised qualifications in trades, healthcare, ICT, and more — often leading to employment faster than university and at lower cost
- ☐ C. Is less respected than university degrees in Kenya
- ☐ D. Only covers computer courses

3. 3. Which of the following is a skill that AI CANNOT replace in the workplace?

- ☐ A. Calculating large datasets quickly
- ☒ B. Human empathy, ethical judgment, creative problem-solving, and leadership of people
- ☐ C. Translating documents between languages
- ☐ D. Recognising faces in photographs

4. 4. Which career sector is Kenya's LARGEST employer and a growing opportunity for young people?

- ☐ A. Tech startups only
- ☒ B. Agriculture and agri-business — employing over 40% of Kenyans and transforming with modern techniques
- ☐ C. International airlines
- ☐ D. Mining only

5. 5. Entrepreneurship as a career path in Kenya:

- ☐ A. Is only possible with large amounts of start-up capital
- ☒ B. Is a legitimate and growing path — especially with mobile money (M-Pesa), low-cost digital tools, and youth enterprise funds available
- ☐ C. Rarely succeeds in Kenya
- ☐ D. Only works in Nairobi

6. 6. What is the Kenyan Jua Kali sector?

- ☐ A. A government ministry for weather
- ☒ B. The informal economy of artisans, craftspeople, welders, mechanics, tailors, and small manufacturers — a major source of employment and income
- ☐ C. A type of university scholarship
- ☐ D. A television programme about careers

7. 7. What does 'lifelong learning' mean in the context of career planning?

- ☐ A. Studying at university for many years without stopping

☒ B. Continuously developing new skills and knowledge throughout your career — because the job market changes and those who stop learning get left behind

☐ C. Reading the same books every year

☐ D. Attending school until you are 30

8. 8. A mentor in career development is:

☐ A. Someone who does all your career planning for you

☒ B. An experienced person in your field of interest who shares knowledge, opens doors, and guides your growth — one of the most valuable career assets

☐ C. A person who only gives you money for your business

☐ D. A university professor only

9. 9. Which of the following best describes a 'portfolio' in career terms?

☐ A. A wallet for keeping money

☒ B. A collection of your work samples, projects, certificates, and achievements that demonstrates your skills and value to potential employers or clients

☐ C. A government document for job seekers

☐ D. A type of university degree

10. 10. What is the MOST important financial habit for a young Kenyan starting their first job or business?

☐ A. Spending all earnings to enjoy life while young

☒ B. Saving and investing a portion of every income — even small amounts — consistently from the start, using tools like M-Pesa savings, SACCOs, or bank accounts

☐ C. Borrowing money to invest immediately

☐ D. Waiting until you earn a large salary to start saving

Part C: Short Answer (25 marks)

1. 1. The process of understanding your strengths, values, interests, and personality before choosing a career is called _____. (3 marks)

2. 2. Kenya's informal sector of artisans, mechanics, tailors, and craftspeople working outdoors is known as the _____ Kali sector. (3 marks)

3. 3. TVET stands for Technical and _____ Education and Training. (3 marks)

4. 4. An experienced person in your field who guides your growth, shares knowledge, and opens doors to opportunity is called a _____. (3 marks)

5. 5. A collection of your work samples, projects, and certificates that demonstrates your skills to employers or clients is called a _____. (3 marks)

6. Describe FOUR different education pathways available to a Kenyan student after Form 4 (KCSE), and explain ONE advantage of each. (4 marks marks) (4 marks)

7. Explain THREE specific human skills that AI cannot replace — and for each, give a real Kenyan job example where that skill is essential. (3 marks marks) (3 marks)

8. You have a friend who wants to become a nurse but her parents insist she study accounting because 'it pays more.' Using what you have learned, write what advice you would give her about making this career decision. (3 marks marks) (3 marks)